to air and cleanliness, where prisoners have no employment. Humanity to them, and also to their keepers and visitors, demands this. The observation of a sensible magistrate at Hanover, here occurs to my mind: "We have found," says he, "that the convicts or slaves who are committed for life, ruin the morals of those who are condemned only for a year or two; therefore, by a late regulation in the electorate, they are now kept apart." Such a regulation here would be beneficial in every view.

PARIS. In or near Paris the principal prisons were the Conciergerie, Grand and Petit Châtelet, For-l'Evêque, L'Abbaye, and the Bicêtre. But at my visit in 1783 I found two of the worst of them, Petit Châtelet and For-l'Evêque, with their horrid dungeons, entirely demolished. The debtors now are sent to a new prison, the Hôtel de la Force; and criminals are sent to the Conciergerie, or the Grand Châtelet. The king's declaration for this alteration, dated the 30th of August, 1780, contains some of the most humane and enlightened sentiments respecting the conduct of prisons. It mentions the construction of airy and spacious infirmaries for the sick; separate places of confinement, and courts, for men and women, and for prisoners of different classes; and a total abolition of underground dungeons, upon this principle, that it is unjust, that those who may possibly be innocent, should beforehand suffer a rigorous punishment.

Most prisons in the city have three or four doors, from four feet to four and a half high, separated from each other by a little area or court. Within the inner door is, in some prisons, a turnstile. The number and lowness of the doors (at each of which you must stoop) and the turnstiles, effectually prevent the prisoners rushing out.

In most of the prisons there are five or six turnkeys, viz., two or three at the doors: one walking in the court, to prevent conferring and plotting (a circumstance to which French gaolers are very attentive): one at the women's ward: and every day one of them is abroad, or otherwise at leisure. This liberty they have in rotation. They are strictly prohibited, under severe penalties, from receiving anything of the prisoners, directly or indirectly, on any pretence whatever. The gaoler is obliged to board them; and to pay each of them at least one hundred livres a year.

I was surprised at seeing that none of the prisoners in the courts were in irons. No gaoler (I was informed) may put

them on a prisoner, without an express order from the judge. And yet in some of the prisons, there were more criminals than in any of our London gaols. When I was first there, the number had been recently increased by an insurrection on account of the scarcity of corn. My reader will perhaps presently see reason to conclude, that the manner in which prisons are conducted makes the confinement more tolerable, and chains less needful. Indeed it was evident, from the very appearance of the prisoners in some of the gaols, that humane attention was paid to them.

Most of the courts are paved; and they are washed in summer once or twice a day. One would hardly believe how this freshens the air in the upper rooms. I felt this very sensibly once and again when I was in the chambers: and an Englishman, who had the misfortune to be a prisoner, made the same remark. I seldom or never found in any French prison that offensive smell which I had often perceived in English gaols. I sometimes thought these courts were the cleanest places in Paris. One circumstance that contributed to it, besides the number of turnkeys, was that most of them were near the river.

As prisoners are not properly separated, it is difficult to keep such as become the king's evidence apart from the rest: the gaoler of Le Petit Châtelet was obliged to fit up a separate room for that purpose.

Prisoners, especially criminals, attend mass almost every day, and the gaoler or a turnkey with them: but such of them as are Protestants are excused. No person is admitted into any prison during the time of divine service.

As condemned criminals generally throw off all reserve, and by relating their various adventures and success, prove pernicious tutors to young and less practised offenders; care is taken to prevent this mischief, by sending those who are sentenced to the galleys, to a separate prison, La Tournelle, near the Port de St. Bernard; where they are kept till the time for their being carried off. Before they are sent hither they are branded.

To prevent the frequent consequences of desperation, no one condemned to death by the inferior court is without hopes of life, till the Parliament confirms or reverses the sentence: and they never make known their decision, till the morning of the day on which a prisoner is to suffer. Then they publish a confirmation of the former sentence; and it is sold in the streets. Executions are often in the afternoon: the last that I saw was